Join the Discord!

DevLUp FSU GBM #6

Pixel Art

22 October, 2026

Our Meeting Schedule:

Date	GBM	GBM Title	Secondary Event	Presenter
		(No Meeting)	ACM Sep 4th	
17 Sep	1	First Meeting		Everyone
24 Sep	2	General introduction to Unity		Yusong
1 Oct	3	Game play and level design		Mitchell
8 Oct	4	Roblox development (free development)		Ashi
15 Oct	5	Modeling in Blender	Game Jam?	Sean
22 Oct	6	Pixel art		Ashi
29 Oct	7	Materials in Blender		Kaydence
5 Nov	8	voice acting in games		Laura
12 Nov	9	Music in games		Marco
19 Nov	10	The math behind game dev		Miles
3 Dec	11	End of Fall celebration		Everyone

Lesson Plan

- ➔ What is (and isn’t) Pixel Art?
- ➔ Why is Pixel Art Useful for Games?
- ➔ Lines
- ➔ Palettes & Ramps
- ➔ Important Techniques
- ➔ Review with Pedro Medeiros
- ➔ The Part Where I Make You Try It


#👀showoff

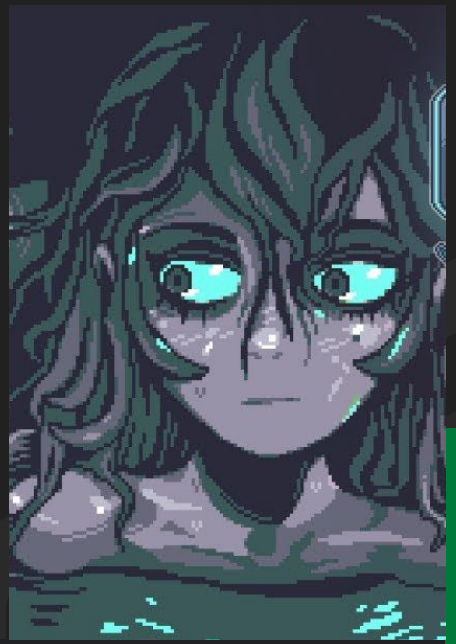
Announcements



What is (and isn’t) Pixel Art?

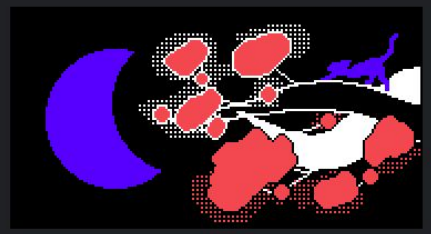
- ➔ Pixels must be deliberate
- ➔ Colors are (usually) limited
  - ◆ Dithering bridges color gaps
  - ◆ Palette often picked out beforehand
- ➔ Aligned to a grid
  - ◆ Anti-aliased manually
  - ◆ Resolution is noticeably constrained

Pixel Art









Not Pixel Art









Pixel Art?









Not Pixel Art?





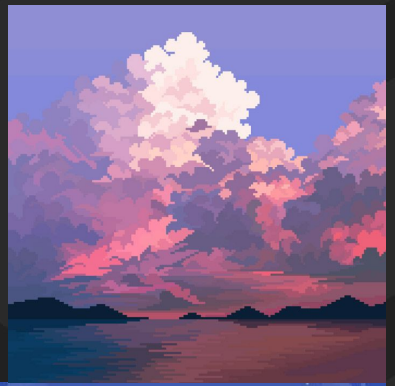
Best Pixel Art Converters Compared (2025): Which Tool Fits Your Workflow? | Pixel Art Village

Why is Pixel Art Useful for Games?

- Economical
  - Fast to make and iterate on
  - Fewer colors = faster and better recoloring
  - Easy for computers to render
- Highly stylized, fantastic for artistic identity
- Sight-readable by players
- Timeless

it’s lowk gorgeous











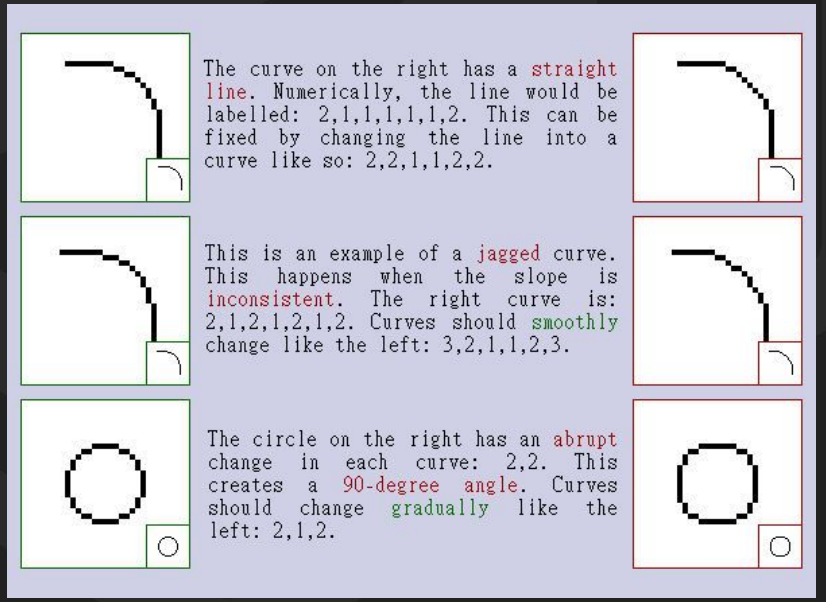


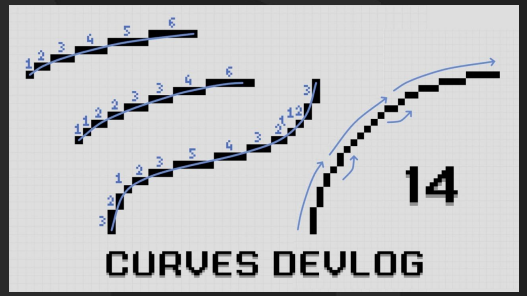
Lines

Lines are an art fundamental. **It's important that we get them right.**

In pixel art, **straight lines** will have a step length that **always** follows a **uniform pattern.**

Curves will always have a decreasing step length.

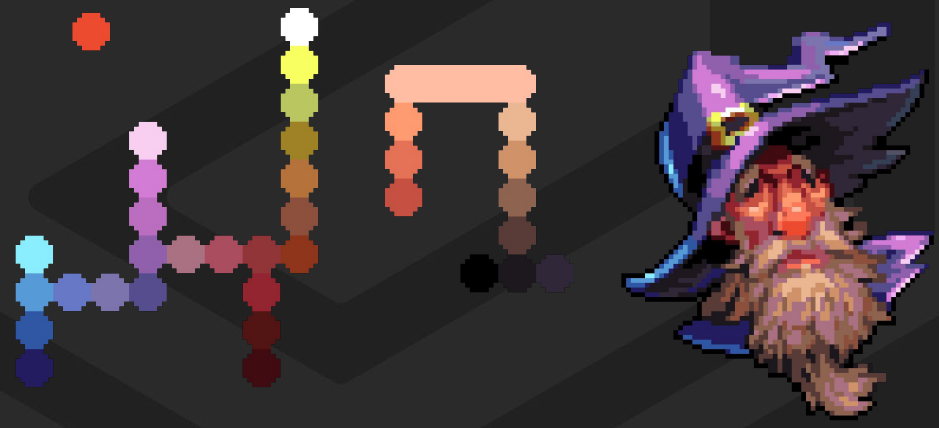


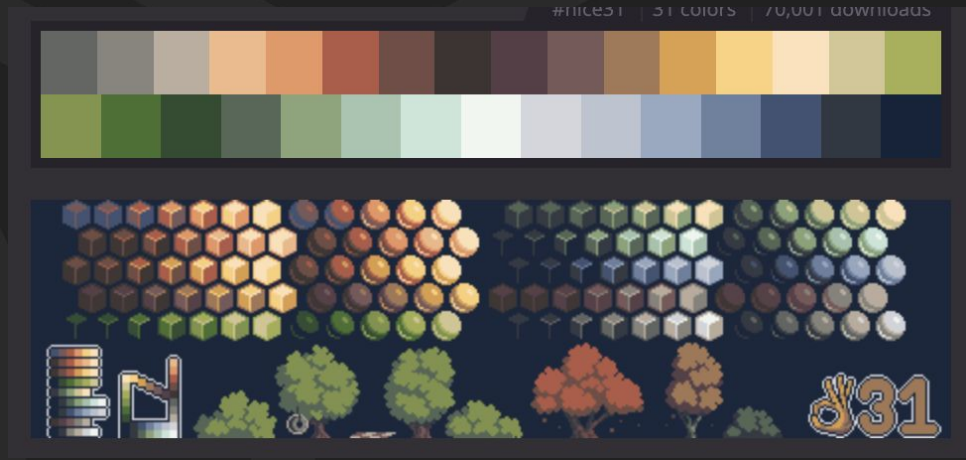


Palettes & Ramps

A **ramp** is a sequence of shades that moves from dark to light.

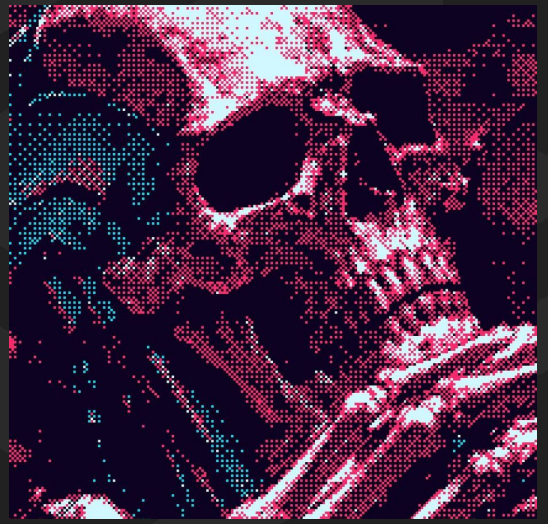
A **palette** is the exclusive set of colors you use on a piece, often composed of multiple ramps.



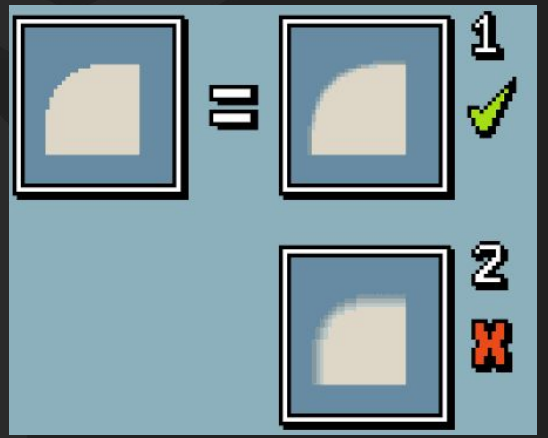


Important Techniques

Dithering: patterns of colors that . Many pixel art programs have tools that can automate this for you.



Anti-Aliasing: blending edges with low-contrast colors.



Review with Pedro Medeiros



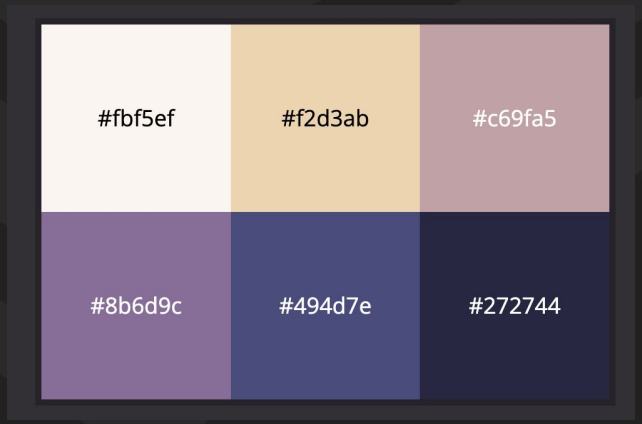


Tutorials: https://saint11.art/blog/pixel-art-tutorials

The Part Where I Make You Try It

First, we're going to do something **together.** I've already picked out a palette for you to use.

Download the .gpl file from the palette's page **OR** from #general



- ➔ **Palette**: https://lospec.com/palette-list/oil-6
- ➔ **Piskel**: https://www.piskelapp.com/p/create/sprite

The Part Where I Make You Try It

Pick out a color palette with your table. Everyone at your table is going to use the same one.

We will make three pieces. First a 12x12, then a 32x32, and finally, a 64x64.

- ➔ **Palette List**: https://lospec.com/palette-list
- ➔ **Piskel**: https://www.piskelapp.com/p/create/sprite